Axles and alignment

antocciphysics

Name: _____ **Block:** _____ (teacher only) **Mastery Rating:** _____

LEARNING TARGET Use measurements and observations to improve straight rolling.

SUCCESS CRITERIA - I can...

1. Check axle parallelism and wheel clearance.
2. Record a repeatable alignment test.
3. Use evidence to choose one adjustment.

Core: teacher selects from 1-7. **Stretch:** 8 after checking your work.

MARZANO SELF-CHECK

① Need help starting

② Can do part; need help

③ Solve and explain with allowed supports

01 Warm-up: bring back an earlier idea

A motor uses 5 W for 7 s. Find electrical energy and name a possible non-mechanical output.

Marzano check - circle: ① ② ③

02 Worked example: explain the model

Reference: clearance = available gap - part width.
Use positive clearance and check free rotation. Alignment and wheel rubbing are separate checks; change one feature at a time.

Worked reasoning: Parallel axles can still cause drag if wheels rub the chassis. Alignment and clearance are separate checks; a straight top view does not verify free rotation.

Your turn: Draw a top view and a side detail marking an axle direction and a wheel gap.



Marzano check - circle: ① ② ③

03 Read and interpret the model

On your top-view sketch, mark both axle lines. Add a check for parallelism and show clearance between each wheel and the chassis.



Marzano check - circle: ① ② ③

04 Apply the physics

A sample free-roll test ends 100 cm forward and 8 cm right of the starting line. Label that result. Plan three trials before and three after one alignment adjustment; record actual measurements only after testing.

Design / trial	Forward (cm)	Side offset (cm)
Before 1	____	____
Before 2	____	____
Before 3	____	____
After 1	____	____
After 2	____	____
After 3	____	____

Marzano check - circle: ① ② ③

05 Explain your reasoning

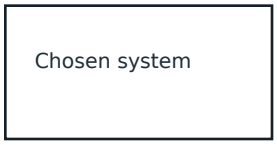
A car veers right once. Does that prove the rear axle is crooked? Name another possible cause and a discriminating check.

Marzano check - circle: 1 2 3

06 Review: connect an earlier idea

A 4 W device runs for 6 s. Find transferred energy. Label input, useful output and other energy transfers.

Draw and label all energy transfers across the boundary.



Stored energy change: _____ J

Marzano check - circle: 1 2 3

07 Exit check

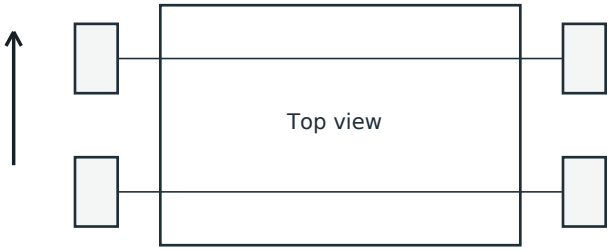
Write the single adjustment you made and one observation that will tell you whether it helped.



Marzano check - circle: 1 2 3

08 STRETCH: test the model

A car veers left. Propose two different causes and a test that separates them before changing both at once.



Marzano check - circle: 1 2 3